AVIGHNA BOQ

Avighna BOQ
User & Operations Guide

Drop a drawing. Get the measurement sheet, the BOQ abstract and the material requirement — in one Excel file.

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Avighna Group · Internal tool

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1 What the application does

Avighna BOQ turns a construction drawing into a quantity take-off. A site engineer uploads a drawing (DWG preferred; DXF, PDF and images also work). The system reads the rooms, doors, windows, walls, slabs, columns and beams from it, measures every item the way a quantity surveyor would, and produces an Excel file with three linked results:

1. Drop the drawing
DWG / DXF / PDF / image. One floor or area per job.

→

2. AI + engine read it
Rooms, openings, walls, slabs, members, other items — with sizes, finishes and evidence.

→

3. Measurement Sheet
Item-wise blocks, one row per drawing object, Nos × L × B × H, deductions as minus rows (IS 1200).

→

4. BOQ abstract
One line per item with description, quantity and unit. Rates are left blank.

→

5. Material requirement
Cement bags, sand, tiles, paint, steel… = quantity × norm × wastage.

Everything that comes out of the system is **traceable**. Every row of the measurement sheet points to a drawing object (a wall, a door, a room). Every element the AI read carries a confidence score and an evidence note. Every quantity in the BOQ is a live Excel formula that links back to the measurement sheet. Reviewers can correct any element in the browser and recompute; the Excel is produced only from the corrected data.

What it is not

- It is **not a pricing tool**. Rates and amounts are intentionally blank in the BOQ; your estimator fills them in Excel.
- It is **not a replacement for a bar bending schedule**. Reinforcement steel is a thumb-rule estimate (kg per cum) and is flagged as such.
- It does **not guess silently**. When the drawing does not give a size, the element is skipped or marked low-confidence and a warning is shown.

Where to find it. Web app: `https://avighna-boq.vercel.app` · API: `https://avighna-boq.onrender.com` · On the development Mac: `http://localhost:3000`. Sign in with the account your administrator created for you.

2 Who uses it — roles

Each user has one role. The role decides which buttons are visible and which actions the server accepts.

Role	Typical person	Can do	Cannot do

Engineer	Site / planning engineer, junior QS	Create jobs (upload drawings), watch processing, correct elements and recompute, download the Excel once a job is *Ready for review*, reprocess a job.	Approve or send back a job; manage users.
Reviewer	Senior QS, project manager	Everything an engineer can, plus **Approve** (signs the job off) and **Send back** with a note (reopens it for correction).	Manage users or system settings.
Admin	IT / head of department	Everything, plus the **Users** page: invite users, set roles, reset passwords, deactivate accounts; see the audit log, system status and backups.	—

All sensitive actions (sign-in, element edits, approvals, user changes) are written to the audit log with the user's e-mail and time.

3 Key terms, explained simply

Job	One upload = one job. A job holds the drawing files, the sheets read from them, the elements, the measurement result and the Excel. Name it by project and floor (e.g. "Nishika Elysium — 6th floor").
Sheet	One page of a PDF, or one layout of a DWG/DXF (usually the *Model* space). Each sheet is classified (floor plan, finishes plan, door schedule, elevation, …) and gets a preview image.
Elements	What was read from the drawing, in six groups: **Rooms** (name, L × W × H, area, finishes), **Openings** (doors, windows, ventilators with W × H and count), **Walls** (RCC / block / partition with L, thickness, H), **Slabs**, **Columns & beams**, and **Other items** (anything countable: furniture, fixtures, counters, thresholds).
Assumptions	Project-level defaults used when a value is not on the drawing: floor height, wall thickness, slab thickness, construction type (Mivan / conventional), concrete grade. Editable on the Elements tab.
Confidence	How sure the reader is about an element, from 0 to 100 %. Anything the AI had to infer (e.g. a height not on the drawing) is marked low; anything you edit becomes 100 %.
Evidence	A short note of where the value came from: the text on the drawing, the dimension line, the schedule row, or "edited by …".
Measurement Sheet	The detailed take-off. Grouped by item (e.g. "12 mm internal plaster"). Each row is one object from the drawing with No. × L × B × H = Qty. Deductions (doors, windows) appear as minus rows. Each block ends with a total.

BOQ (Abstract)	The summary: one line per item with a CPWD-style description, the total quantity (linked to the measurement sheet), the unit, and blank rate / amount columns.
Material Requirement	For every BOQ line, the materials needed: BOQ quantity × consumption norm × (1 + wastage %). Summed per material at the bottom (e.g. total cement bags).
Basis	How a BOQ line was obtained: measured from drawing objects, thumb rule (steel kg/cum — replace with BBS), or manual.
Status	Where a job is in its life: Queued → Converting → Analysing → Extracting → Quantifying → **Ready for review** → **Approved**. **Failed** if something went wrong (the message says what).

4 Quick start in 6 steps

1. **Sign in** at the web address with your e-mail and password. On first sign-in you set your own password.
2. Click **New measurement**. Enter the project name and the floor / level. Drop the drawing files (DWG preferred). Click **Upload & measure**.
3. Wait for the status to reach **Ready for review** (typically 2–5 minutes per sheet; large DWGs take longer). The pipeline panel on the right shows each step.
4. Open the **Elements** tab. Check the rooms, openings and walls against the drawing. Fix anything wrong, add what is missing, then click **Save & recompute**.
5. Read the **Measurement Sheet**, **BOQ** and **Materials** tabs. Warnings at the top tell you what to double-check.
6. A reviewer clicks **Approve**. Anyone clicks **Download Excel** to get the workbook with live formulas.

5 Step 1 — Sign in

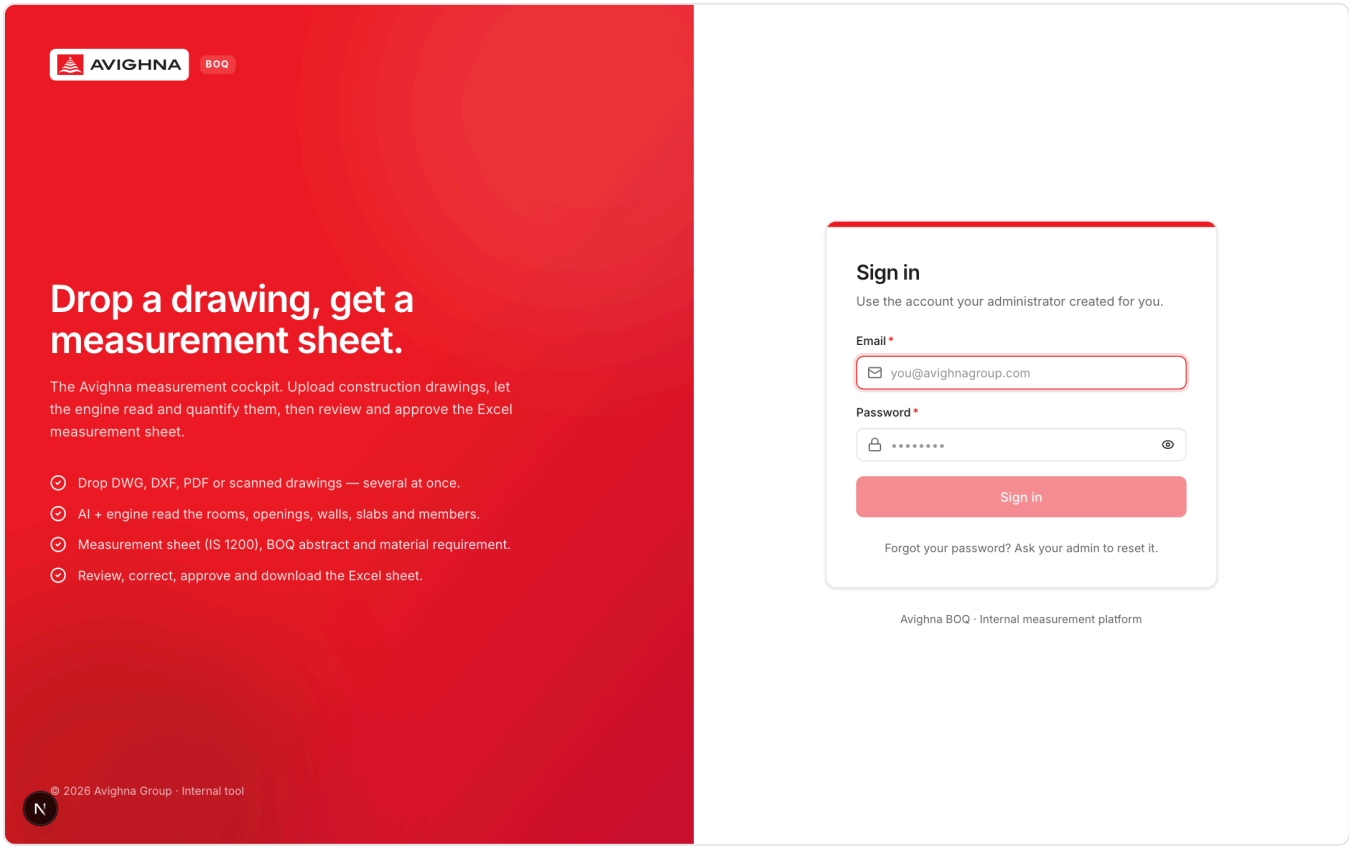


Figure 1 — The sign-in page. Accounts are created by an administrator; there is no self-registration.

- Enter the e-mail and password your administrator gave you. A temporary password must be changed at first sign-in; the app asks for a new one automatically.
- Sessions last 12 hours. After that you are asked to sign in again.
- Forgot your password? Ask an admin to reset it; they will give you a new temporary password (shown to them once).
- Repeated wrong passwords temporarily block sign-in for that account; wait a few minutes and try again.

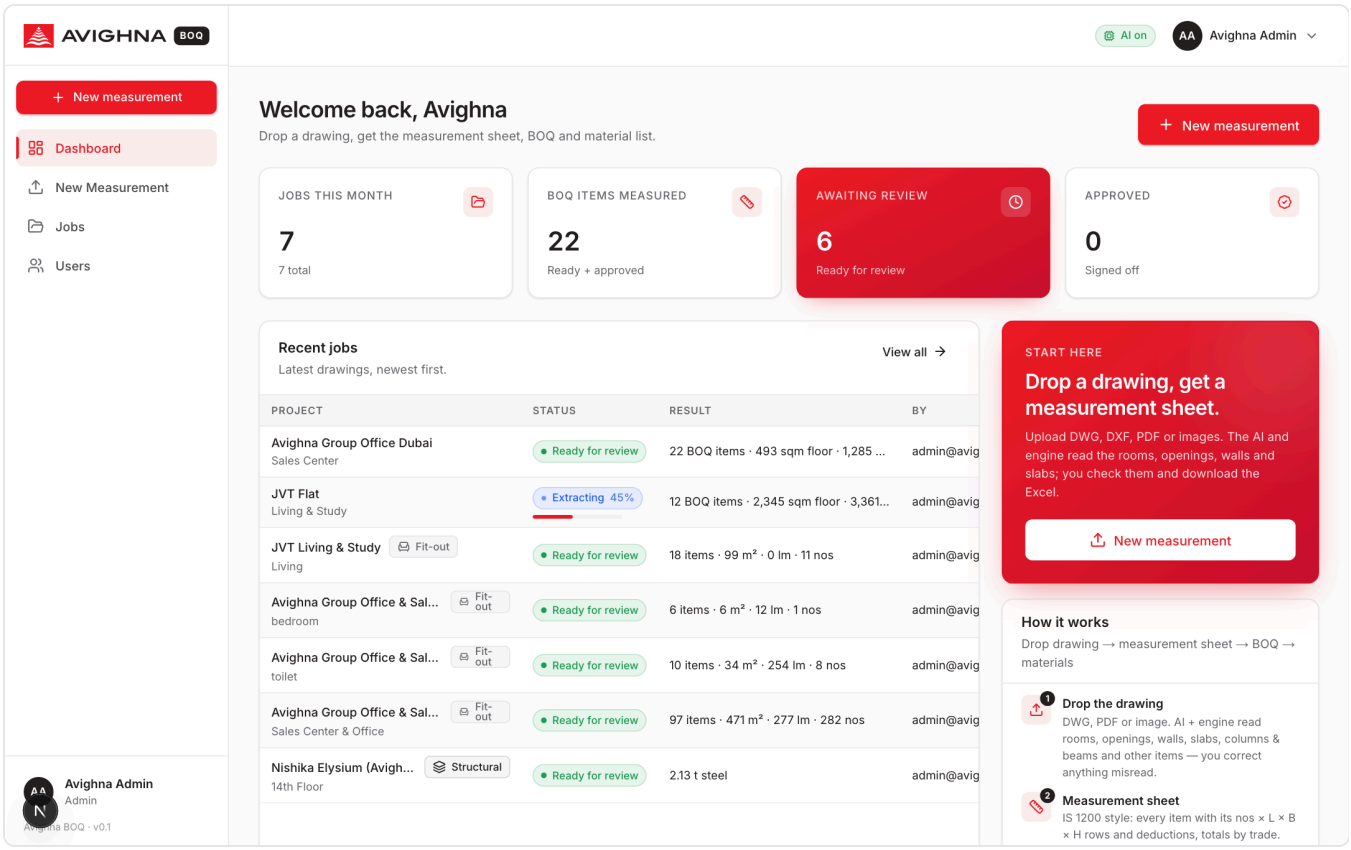


Figure 2 — The dashboard after sign-in: counters, recent jobs, a "Start here" card and the three-step "How it works" panel.

6 Step 2 — Create a new measurement

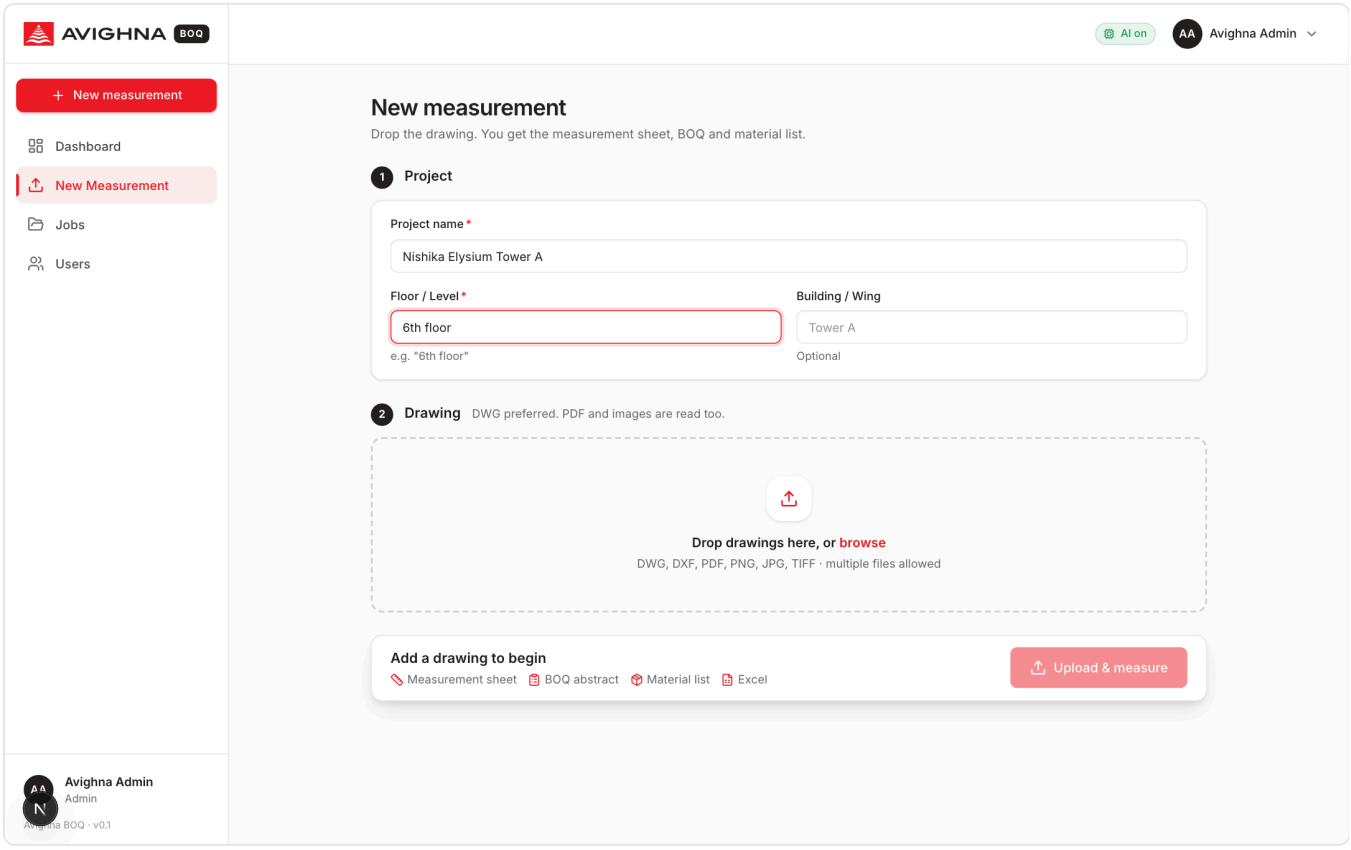


Figure 3 — New measurement: project details and the drawing drop zone.

Project name required	The project the drawing belongs to. Appears in the Excel title and the job list.
Floor / Level required	Which floor or area the drawing shows, e.g. "6th floor", "Sales centre", "Typical floor 6–17". Used in every measurement-sheet row and lets you compare floors later.
Building / Wing	Optional: tower or wing name.
Drawing files	Drop one or more files: **DWG** (best — exact vector text and geometry), **DXF**, **PDF** (vector plots are read exactly; scanned PDFs are read from the image), **PNG / JPG / TIFF**. Up to 200 MB per upload.

Which files to upload together

- Put **one floor (or one area) in one job**. Upload the plan plus its supporting sheets: the floor finishes plan, the door / window schedule, and section or detail sheets that carry heights. The reader merges them — a door schedule gives sizes and counts, the plan gives which room each door is in.
- Do not mix two different floors in one job; create a job per floor instead (the Excel has a per-floor "Tender vs Site" template).
- Xref base plans are useful but not required; the sheet that carries the room names and dimensions matters most.

Click **Upload & measure**. The browser shows the upload progress and then opens the job page.

7 Step 3 — Processing and job status

The job page shows the current status at the top and a **Pipeline** panel on the right with every step and its time. You can leave the page; processing continues on the server.

Status	What is happening	Typical duration
Queued	Waiting for a free worker.	seconds
Converting	DWG files are converted to DXF (LibreDWG); the real file type is detected from the bytes, not the extension.	5–90 s per DWG
Analysing	Every sheet is read into a text inventory (exact vector text with coordinates), a preview image is rendered, and the sheet is classified (floor plan, finishes plan, door schedule, elevation, …).	10 s – 3 min per sheet
Extracting	The AI reads each relevant sheet (image + exact text + measured CAD facts) into elements. Sheets that cannot help (cover, perspective, notes) are skipped.	1–3 min per sheet when the AI service is responsive; up to 10 min on a slow day
Quantifying	The deterministic engine builds the measurement sheet, BOQ and materials. No AI is involved here.	< 1 s
Ready for review	Done. Elements and results can be checked, corrected and downloaded.	—
Approved	A reviewer signed the job off. It is read-only until it is sent back.	—
Failed	Something stopped the job; the last pipeline message says what (e.g. "No sheets could be read"). Fix the input and **Reprocess**.	—

Messages you may see in the pipeline panel. "preview could not be rendered" — the drawing was too heavy to draw within the time limit; the AI still reads the text and CAD facts. "AI reading failed … rooms taken from CAD outlines only" — the AI service did not answer; the fallback reads room names and door tags from the CAD file and shows rooms as equivalent squares at 50 % confidence — check them. "Room X: size missing, skipped" — no dimensions were found for that room; add them on the Elements tab.

8 Step 4 — Check and correct the Elements

This is the most important screen. The measurement sheet, BOQ and materials are all computed from what is on this tab, so five minutes here decide the quality of the whole output.

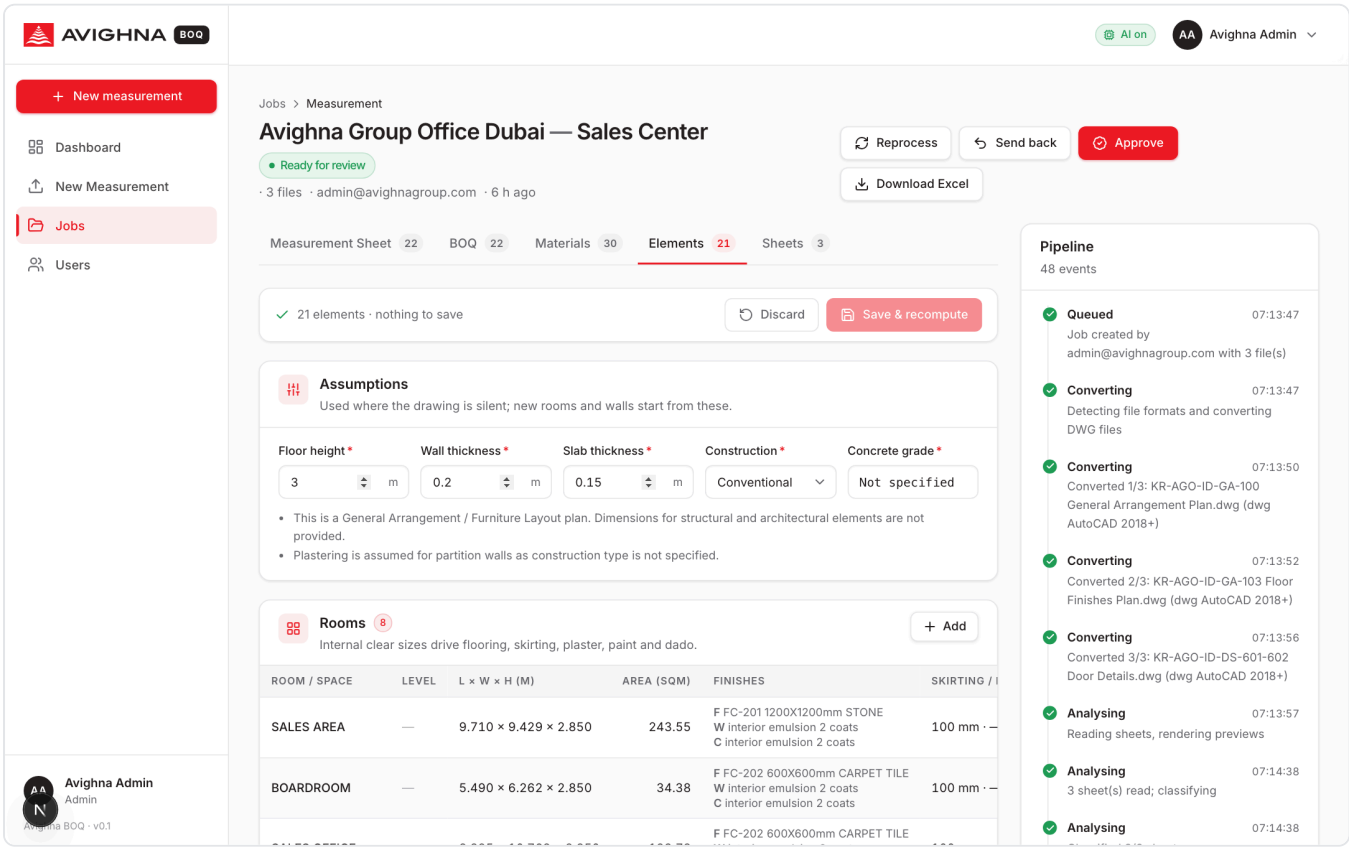


Figure 4 — Elements tab: Assumptions card, then Rooms, Openings, Walls, Slabs, Columns & beams and Other items. Each row shows its confidence; the "i" opens the evidence.

What to check, in order

1. **Assumptions** — floor height, wall thickness, slab thickness, construction type, concrete grade. These fill every blank on the drawing, so set them first.
2. **Rooms** — every room on the plan is listed once, with L × W (or a measured area), height, and the floor / wall / ceiling finish. Mark wet areas (toilets, pantry) so waterproofing and dado are measured. Skirting height and dado height are per room.
3. **Openings** — each door / window type with width, height, count and the room it belongs to. Counts come from the schedule; the room name is used to deduct the opening from that room's plaster, paint and skirting.
4. **Walls, Slabs, Columns & beams** — structural items, if the drawing shows them. Leave empty for a pure finishes job.
5. **Other items** — countable things the AI noticed (reception desk, workstations, counters, thresholds). They go to the BOQ as "nos" / "LS" lines.

Editing

- Click a row (or its pencil) to open the edit dialog. Numbers must be positive; counts must be at least 1.

- **Add** creates a new row in that section; **Delete** removes one (you are asked to confirm).
- Edited rows get confidence 100 % and an evidence note "edited by <you> on <date>".
- Nothing is saved until you press **Save & recompute**. The button is grey until something changed. **Discard** throws the changes away.
- Saving sends the whole element list to the server, recomputes every tab and refreshes the Excel on the next download.

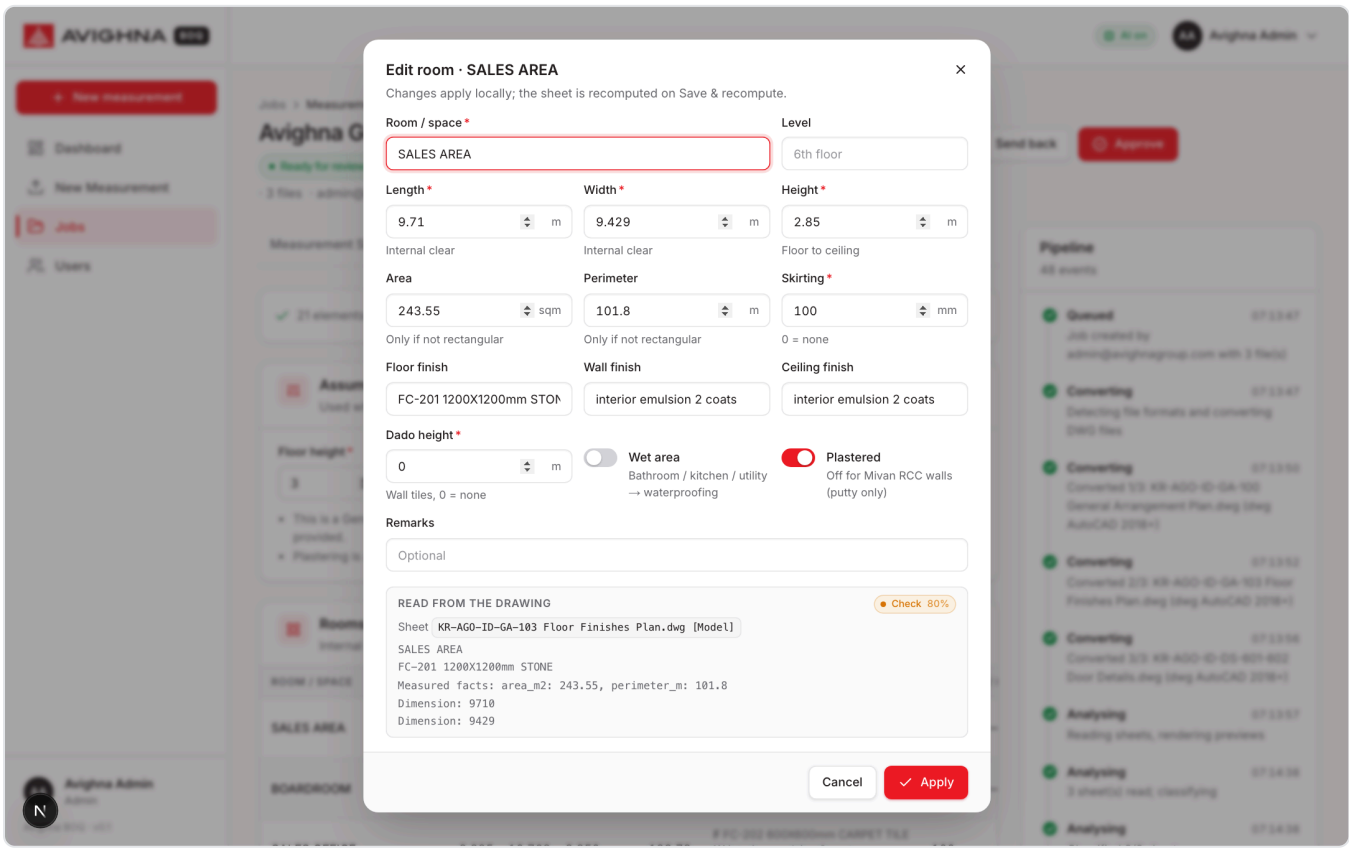


Figure 5 — Editing a room. Finishes drive flooring, skirting, plaster and paint items; "wet area" adds waterproofing and dado.

Rule of thumb. If a value is on the drawing and the app got it wrong, correct it here — never in Excel. The Excel is regenerated from these elements, and a corrected element keeps the audit trail (who changed what, when).

9 Step 5 — Read the Measurement Sheet

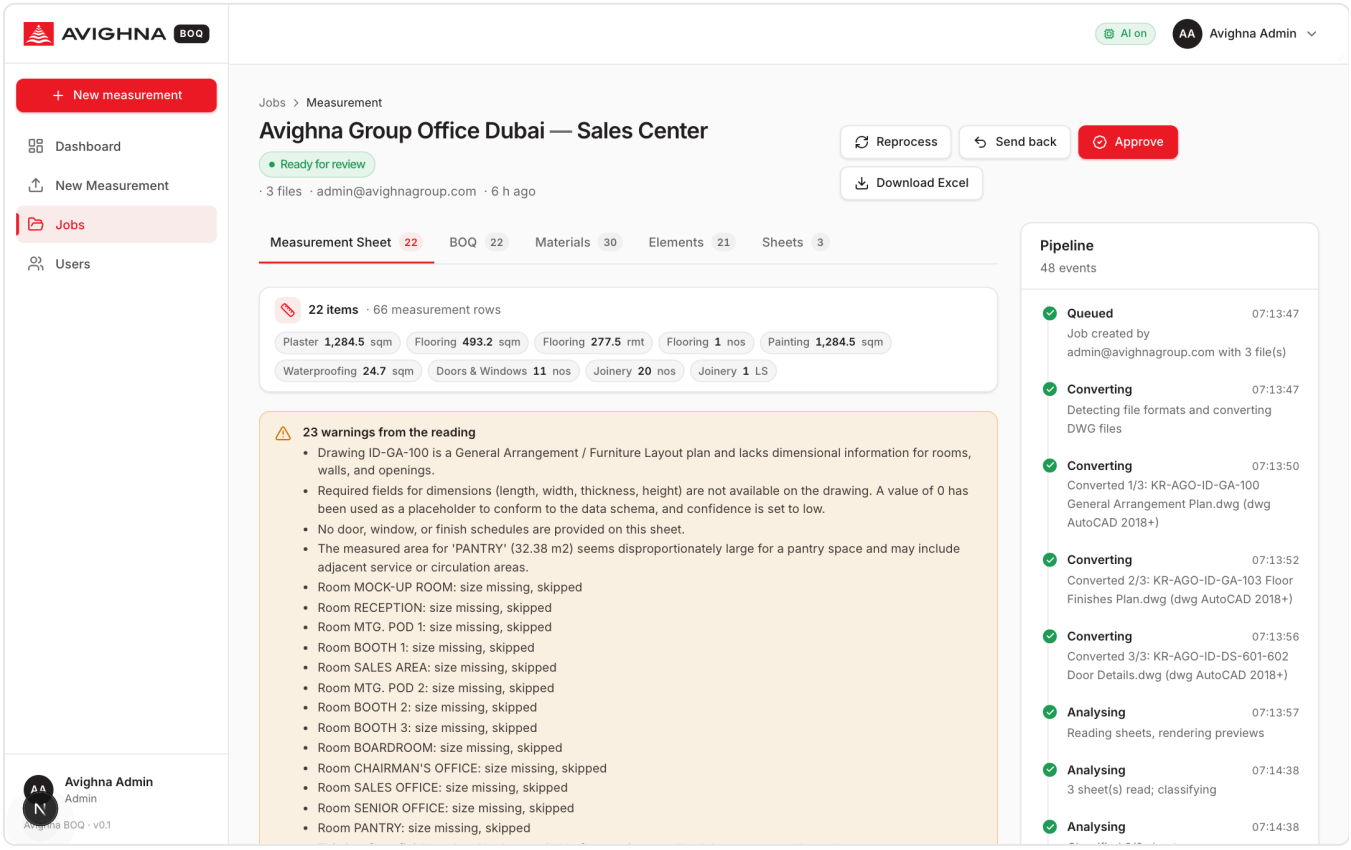


Figure 6 — Measurement Sheet tab: the sticky summary strip (items, totals per trade), warnings from the reading, then one card per item.

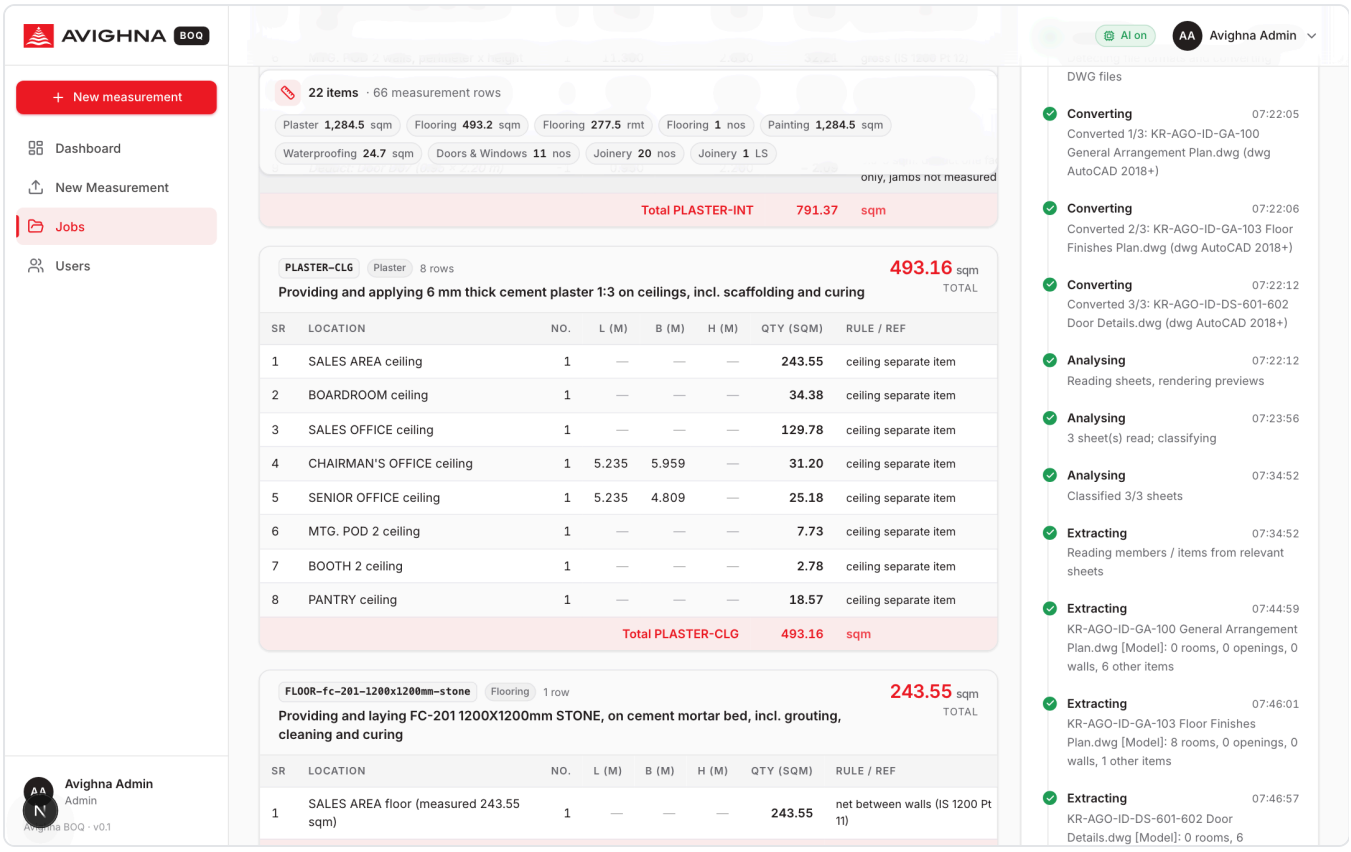


Figure 7 — One item block. Each row is one object from the drawing. Grey rows with "–" are deductions; the red row is the block total that feeds the BOQ.

How to read a block

Column	Meaning
Sr	Row number inside the block.
Location	What and where: "Wall W2, Bedroom 1, 6th floor", "Deduct: Door D1 in W2". This is the link back to the drawing.
No.	How many of this object (negative for deductions; for formwork it is the number of faces).
L, B, H (m)	Length, breadth, height in metres. A blank B or H means that dimension is not part of the item (e.g. plaster is L × H).
Qty	No. × L × B × H in the item's unit (cum, sqm, rmt, nos).
Rule / ref	The measurement rule applied (e.g. "IS 1200 Pt 12: opening > 3 sqm, both faces + jambs") or the source ("door schedule").

The summary strip shows the totals per trade (RCC in cum, Plaster / Flooring / Painting in sqm, Doors in nos, …). The amber box lists warnings from the reading — read them before trusting the numbers.

10 Step 6 — BOQ, Materials and Sheets tabs

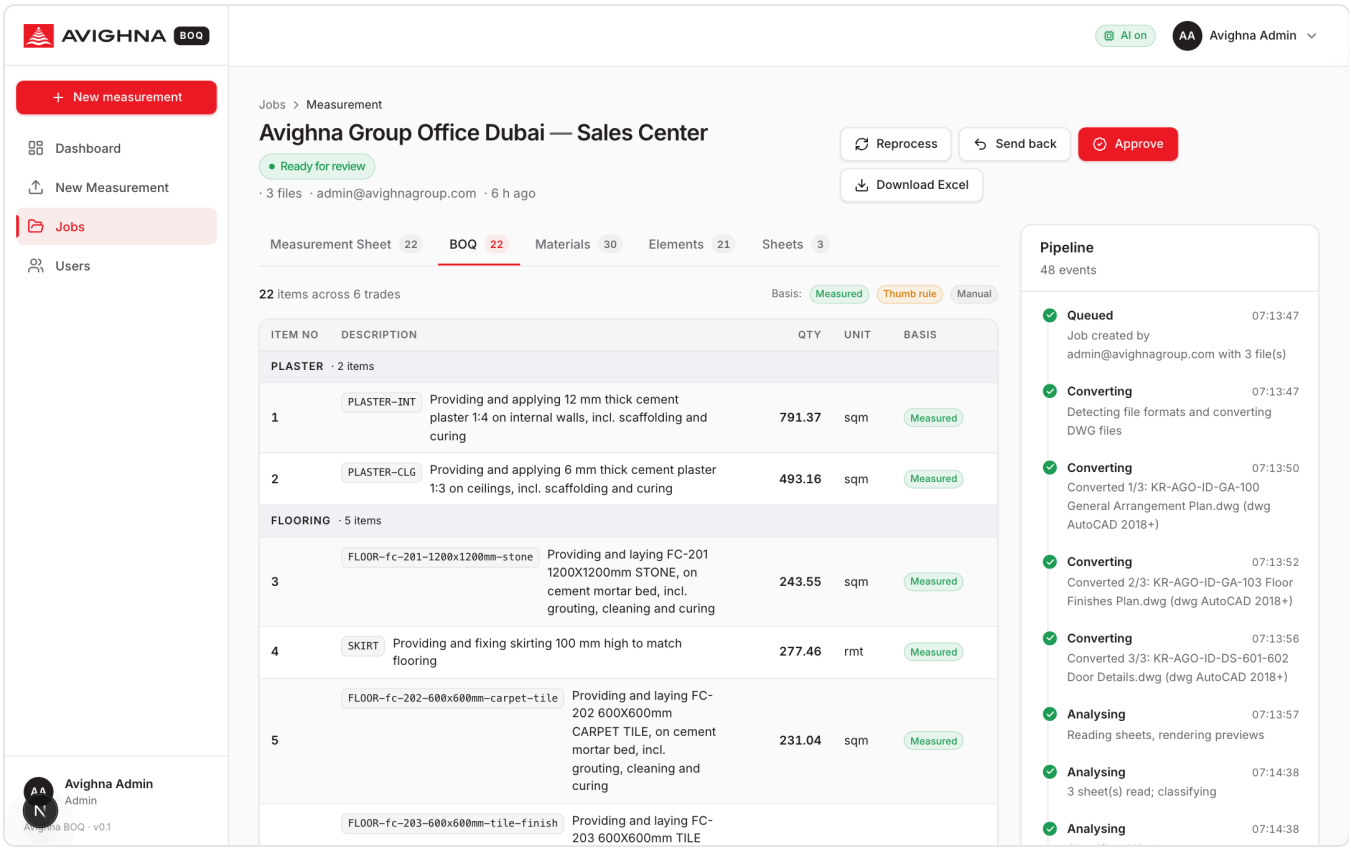


Figure 8 — BOQ tab: one line per item, grouped by trade, with a basis badge. Quantities only; rates are left blank on purpose.

BOQ — the abstract. Item number, CPWD-style description, quantity, unit and basis. **measured** means the quantity comes from measured drawing objects; **thumb rule** is used only for reinforcement steel and must be replaced by a bar bending schedule before tender.

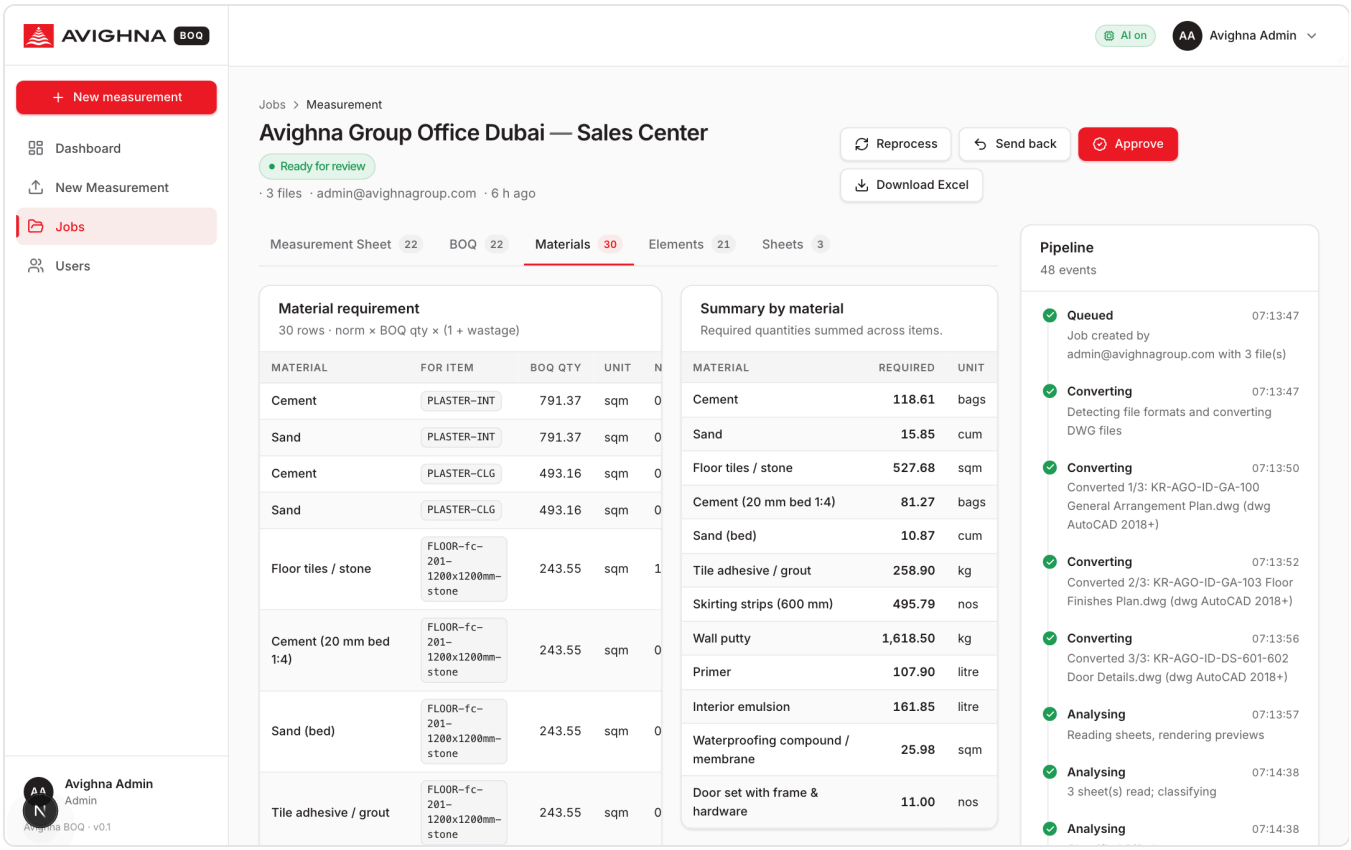


Figure 9 — Materials tab: for each BOQ line the material, norm, wastage and required quantity; a summary by material at the end.

Materials — for each BOQ line, the materials it consumes. Required = BOQ qty × norm × (1 + wastage %). The norms are company standards (Appendix B); an admin can tune them. The summary table at the bottom adds up each material across all items (e.g. total cement bags for plaster + flooring + masonry).

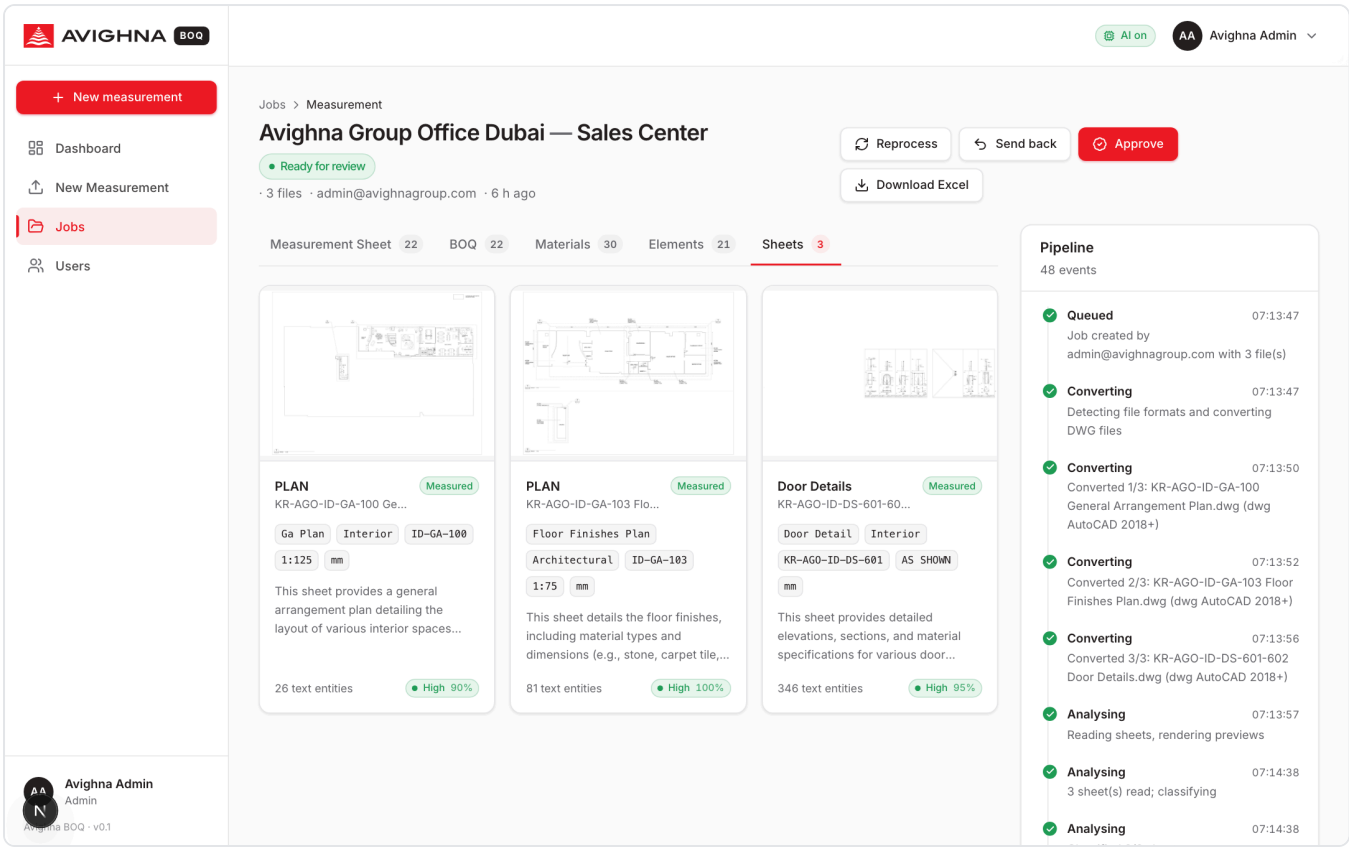


Figure 10 — Sheets tab: every sheet read from the files with its preview, classification and processing notes.

Sheets — what the system saw: each file / page / layout, its preview image, the detected sheet type (floor plan, finishes plan, door schedule, elevation, …), units, drawing number, and processing notes. Use it to confirm that the right sheets were read and that previews rendered.

11 Step 7 — Review, approve, download

Button	Who	What it does
Reprocess	Everyone	Runs the whole pipeline again on the same files (after a settings change, or when the AI service was down). Manual edits are replaced by the new reading.
Save & recompute (Elements tab)	Everyone	Saves corrected elements and recomputes measurement, BOQ and materials.
Approve	Reviewer, Admin	Signs the job off. Status becomes *Approved*; the job is read-only; the Excel is marked approved.
Send back	Reviewer, Admin	Returns an approved or ready job for correction with a note that is shown on the job and stored in the audit log.
Download Excel	Everyone	Available once the job is *Ready for review* or *Approved*. The file name carries the project, level and version.

Suggested workflow. Engineer uploads and corrects elements → Reviewer checks the Elements tab against the drawing, reads the warnings, approves → Estimator downloads the Excel, fills rates in the BOQ tab → Site team uses the Tender vs Site tab during execution.

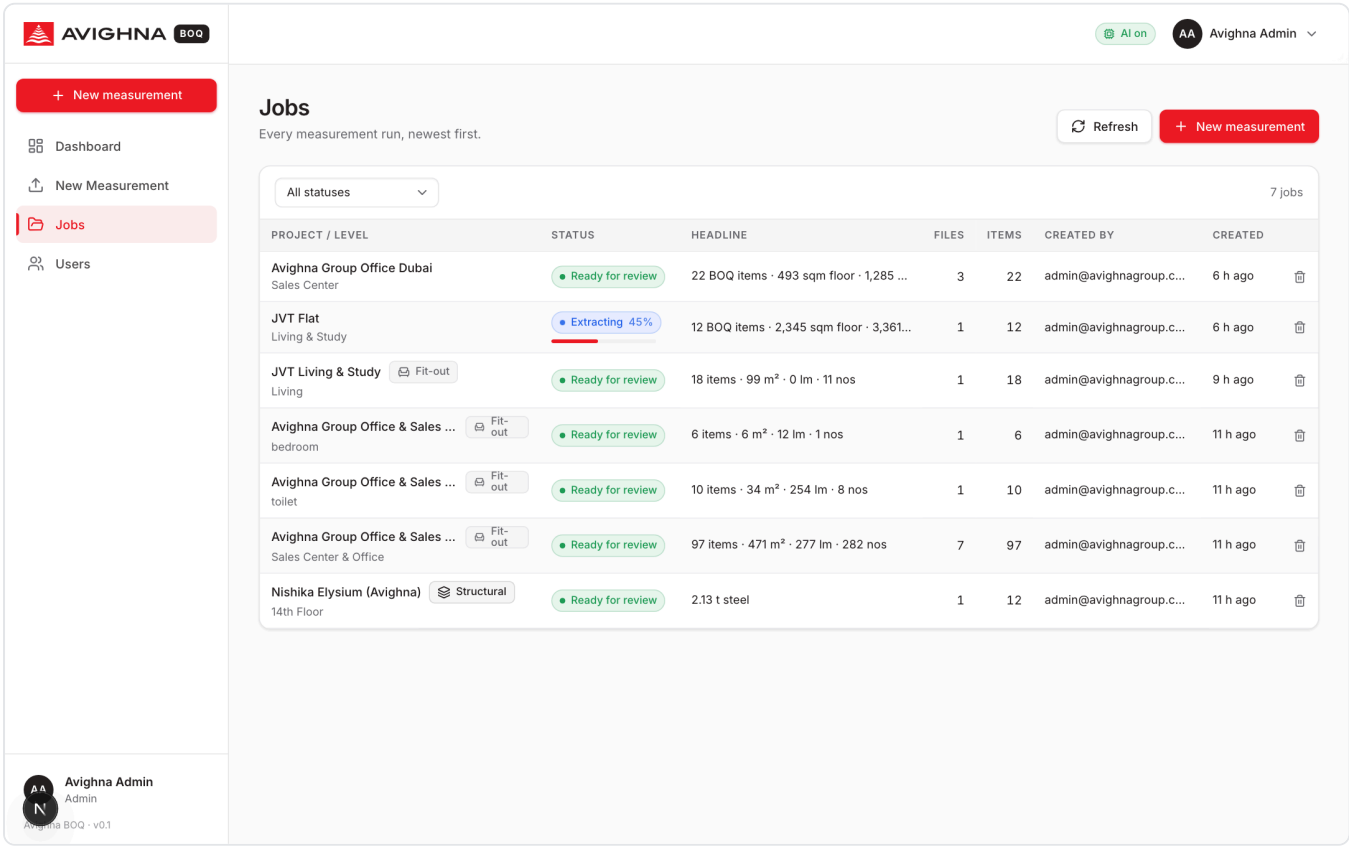


Figure 11 — Jobs list: all jobs with status, result headline, owner and date. Filter by status.

12 The Excel workbook, tab by tab

The workbook is produced by the server from the current elements. All arithmetic is written as live Excel formulas, so an estimator can see and audit every number.

Tab	Contents	Formulas
Measurement Sheet	Title with project, level and drawing numbers. One block per item: item code and description row, then rows Sr | Location | No. | L | B | H | Qty | Unit | Rule / ref. Deduction rows are grey, totals light red.	Qty `=C*D*E*F` (blank dimensions are skipped); block total `=SUM(...)`.
BOQ (Abstract)	Item | Description | Qty | Unit | Rate (INR) | Amount (INR) | Basis, grouped by trade. Total, GST @ 18 % and grand total rows at the end.	Qty `='Measurement Sheet'!G<total row>`; Amount `=Qty*Rate`; totals `=SUM`.
Material Requirement	Material | For item | BOQ qty | Unit | Norm per unit | Wastage % | Required | Material unit | Basis; then a summary by material.	Required `=C*E*(1+F/100)`; BOQ qty linked to the measurement sheet.
Tender vs Site	Template per item: Tender qty (linked), Site measured qty (blank, for the site engineer), Difference and Variation %.	Difference and % as formulas.
Elements (from drawing)	The rooms, openings, walls, slabs, members and other items exactly as read / corrected, with confidence, evidence and source sheet.	—

Do not retype quantities in Excel. Change the element in the app and download again. If you must adjust in Excel, change the measurement-sheet row (L, B, H or No.) — the BOQ and materials follow automatically.

13 How quantities are calculated (rules)

The engine follows IS 1200 (method of measurement of building works) and common Indian QS practice. The rules below are what the measurement sheet applies; every row names the rule it used.

Item	Rule
Flooring (per finish)	Room area (L × W, or the measured area if the drawing gives one). One BOQ item per finish type (e.g. "FC-201 1200×1200 stone").
Skirting	Room perimeter minus the widths of the doors in that room (100 mm high by default, per room).
Internal plaster	Perimeter × height for plastered rooms. Openings: ≤ 0.5 sqm — no deduction; 0.5 to 3 sqm — deduct one face; > 3 sqm — deduct both faces and add jambs and soffits.
Ceiling plaster / paint	Room area.
Wall paint	Same area as internal plaster, same opening rule; the paint system comes from the room's wall finish.
Dado (wall tiles)	Wet areas only: perimeter × dado height, minus door widths × dado height.
Waterproofing	Wet areas only: floor area + 300 mm upturn along the perimeter.
Doors / windows	Counted in nos from the openings list (one item per tag, size and description in the text). Windows also give an area for fabricated items.
RCC walls	Nos × L × thickness × H minus openings (Nos × W × thickness × H).
Formwork to walls	Contact area, both faces: 2 × L × H minus 2 × opening area.
Columns	Concrete W × D × storey height; formwork = perimeter × height (4 sides).
Beams	Concrete W × (D – slab thickness) × L (the part below the slab); formwork = 2 sides + soffit.
Slabs	Concrete L × W × thickness; formwork = soffit minus beam widths.
Block masonry	cum for walls ≥ 150 mm (L × thickness × H minus openings); sqm for thinner partitions.
Reinforcement steel	**Thumb rule**, flagged in the BOQ: walls 125, columns 200, beams 150, slabs 85 kg per cum. Replace with the bar bending schedule for tender.
Other items	Taken as given (nos / rmt / sqm / LS) and placed under their trade.

Rounding: dimensions are kept to 3 decimals; quantities are rounded to 3 decimals in the app and left as formulas in Excel.

14 How the AI reading works and its limits

The AI (Google Gemini 2.5 Pro) does not estimate areas from a picture. For each sheet it receives three things: the **preview image** (for layout), the **exact vector text** of the drawing with coordinates (so numbers are never misread), and **measured CAD facts** computed by the engine from the DXF — room outlines with

area and perimeter, hatch areas with their finish codes, door / window tag counts, polyline lengths. It returns the elements in a strict structure with confidence and evidence. The engine then does all the arithmetic.

What it is good at

- Floor plans with room names and dimension lines; finishes plans with finish tags (FC-201 …); door / window schedules with sizes and counts; general notes with heights and construction type.
- Merging several sheets: the plan gives rooms, the schedule gives sizes, the finishes plan gives materials.

Where to be careful

- **Elevation and section sheets** are not plans: the small coded hatches on them are legend swatches, not areas. Upload them for heights, but check any room that appears only from an elevation.
- **Furniture / general arrangement plans** without dimensions give room names but no sizes. Add the finishes plan or the dimensioned plan in the same job.
- **Scanned PDFs and photos** have no vector text, so numbers are read from the image — expect lower confidence.
- **Very large DWGs** (20 MB and more) may not render a preview within the time limit; the AI then reads from text and CAD facts only, and the pipeline says so.
- When the AI service is unavailable, the fallback produces rooms as equivalent squares at 50 % confidence — use it only as a starting point.

Always check low-confidence rows. The Elements tab counts them in the alert at the top. A value below 70 % means the reader inferred it; confirm it against the drawing.

15 Preparing drawings for best results

- **Export the DWG in AutoCAD 2018 format** (AC1032) with the plan in Model space. Purge unused blocks to reduce size.
- **Name every room** with text inside its outline; keep dimension lines on the plan (overall and room-wise).
- **Use door / window tags** (D1, W2, …) on the plan and include the schedule sheet with width × height and counts.
- **Tag finishes** with codes (FC-201 stone, FC-202 carpet …) pointing into the hatched area via leaders; one hatch per zone.
- **State heights** (floor-to-floor, false ceiling, skirting, dado) in notes or sections — otherwise the Assumptions defaults are used.
- **One floor per job.** For typical floors that repeat, measure one floor and multiply in the BOQ, or create one job per floor to catch differences.
- PDF: prefer the vector plot from AutoCAD over a scan; keep text as text (do not outline fonts).

16 Administrator guide

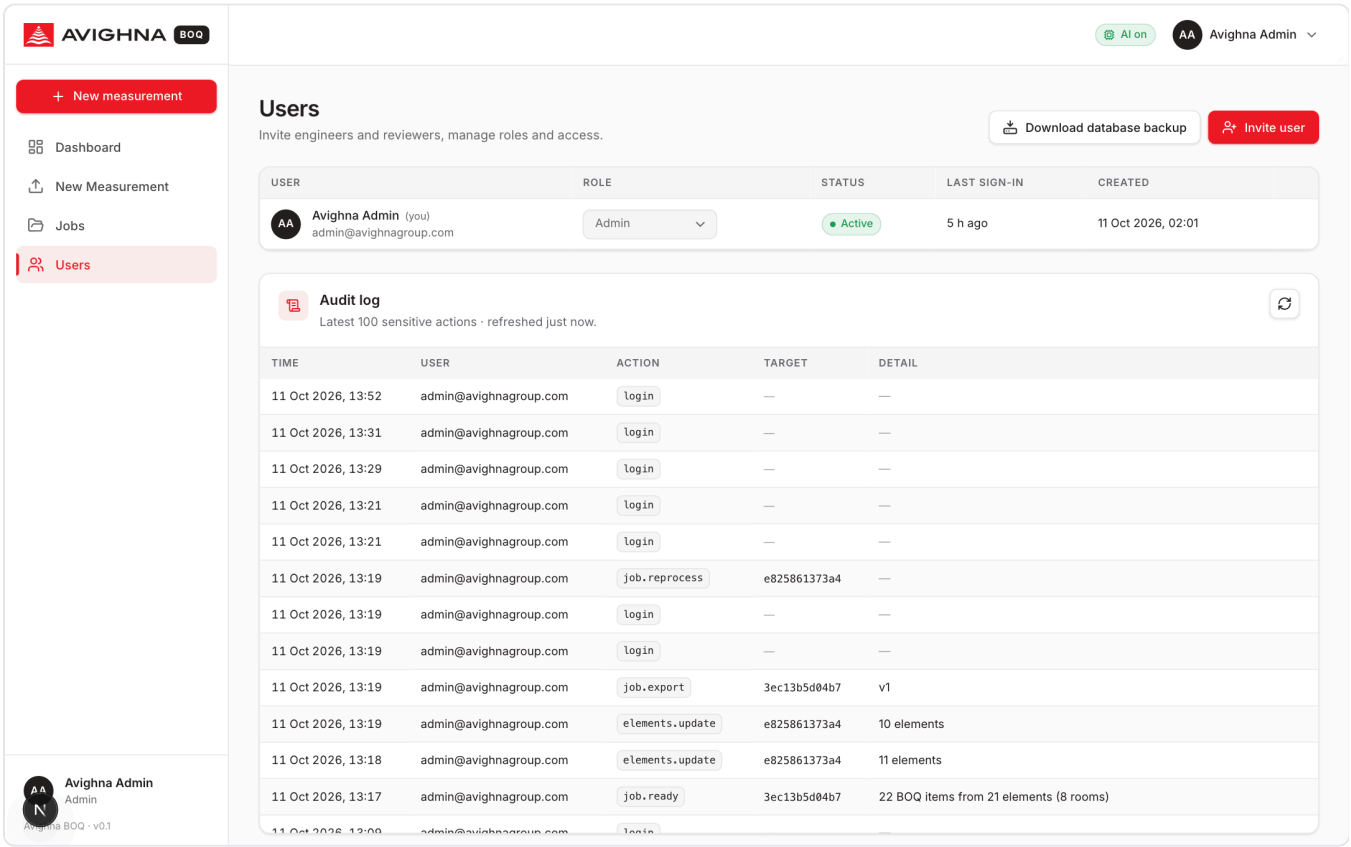


Figure 12 — Users page (admins only): invite, change role, reset password, deactivate; the audit log and system card are below.

Users

- **Invite** a user with name, e-mail and role. A temporary password is shown once — pass it on securely. The user must change it at first sign-in.

- **Change role** at any time (engineer / reviewer / admin). The change applies on the user's next request.
- **Reset password** issues a new temporary password; **Deactivate** blocks sign-in without deleting history.
- The first admin account is created from the server's `BOOTSTRAP_ADMIN_EMAIL` / `BOOTSTRAP_ADMIN_PASSWORD` settings on first start.

System card and audit log

- The **System** card shows the API version, whether AI reading is on and which models are used, which DWG converter is available, database and storage backends, memory limits and worker threads.
- The **Audit log** lists sign-ins, element edits, approvals, send-backs, user changes and settings changes with user and time.
- **Backup**: admins can download a database backup from the API (`GET /api/v1/admin/backup`).

Standards and norms

Material consumption norms and wastage percentages (Appendix B) and the steel thumb rules are company standards kept on the server. Change them through the Standards API (admin) and reprocess or recompute jobs to apply them; the Excel shows which norm was used on every material row.

Server settings (environment variables)

Variable	Purpose
`GEMINI_API_KEY`	Turns AI reading on. Without it the app still runs with the deterministic fallback.
`GEMINI_MODEL_PRO` / `GEMINI_MODEL_FAST`	Models for reading (default gemini-2.5-pro) and classification (gemini-2.5-flash).
`GEMINI_TIMEOUT_S`	Maximum seconds per AI call (default 600). A hung call fails cleanly and the fallback is used.
`DATABASE_URL`	PostgreSQL connection (Supabase in production). Without it a local SQLite file is used.
`STORAGE_BACKEND` + Supabase keys	`supabase` stores uploads, previews and exports in Supabase Storage; otherwise the local data folder.
`CORS_ORIGINS`	Allowed browser origins (the Vercel URL); *.vercel.app and *.onrender.com are allowed by default.
`BOOTSTRAP_ADMIN_EMAIL` / `…_PASSWORD`	First admin account.
`MAX_UPLOAD_MB` , `WORKER_THREADS` , `LIBREDWG_BIN`	Upload limit (200), parallel jobs (2), path to the DWG converter.

Secrets (API keys, database passwords, the Supabase service key) live only in the hosting provider's environment settings. They are never stored in the repository or shown in the app.

17 Architecture, hosting and local setup

Web app (frontend)	Next.js 15 / React 19, hosted on **Vercel** (`avighna-boq.vercel.app`). Talks to the API over HTTPS with a signed-in token.
API (backend)	Python FastAPI, hosted on **Render** as a Docker container (`avighna-boq.onrender.com`). Contains the DWG converter (LibreDWG 0.13.4), the sheet readers, the AI wrapper, the measurement engine and the Excel writer. Two worker threads process jobs in the background.
Database and files	**Supabase**: PostgreSQL for users, jobs, sheets, elements, results and the audit log (row-level security enabled); Supabase Storage for uploaded drawings, previews and Excel files.
AI	Google Gemini 2.5 Pro (reading) and 2.5 Flash (classification), called from the API only.
Deployment	Every push to the `main` branch of `github.com/ajs-avg/Avighna-BOQ` redeploys Vercel (about 1 minute) and Render (about 10 minutes, because the DWG converter is built from source).

Pipeline inside the API

Convert detect type; DWG → DXF; sanitise → **Read sheets** text inventory, preview, classification → **Measure CAD** room outlines, hatch areas, tag counts → **AI extraction** elements with confidence + evidence → **Engine** measurement sheet, BOQ, materials → **Excel** 5 tabs, live formulas

Running on a laptop (development)

```
git clone https://github.com/ajs-avg/Avighna-BOQ.git
cd Avighna-BOQ
# backend (Python 3.12 virtual environment with uv)
cd backend && uv venv --python 3.12 .venv && uv pip install --python .venv/bin/python -r
requirements.txt
cp .env.example .env      # set BOOTSTRAP_ADMIN_*, GEMINI_API_KEY, LIBREDWG_BIN
./run.sh                  # API on http://localhost:8000
# frontend (new terminal)
cd frontend && npm install && npm run dev      # app on http://localhost:3000
# or both at once from the repo root
tools/dev.sh
```

Tests: `cd backend && PYTHONPATH=. .venv/bin/python -m pytest tests -q` (49 tests, SQLite) and `tools/test_postgres.sh` (same tests on an embedded PostgreSQL). Frontend: `npm run typecheck && npm run lint && npm run build`.

18 Troubleshooting and FAQ

Symptom	Cause and what to do
"Cannot reach the API … Is the backend running?" on the sign-in page	The API is down or waking up (Render free instances sleep after idle and take about a minute to wake). Wait and retry; on a laptop start the backend.
Banner "AI reading is off"	No `GEMINI_API_KEY` on the server. Rooms come from CAD outlines only. Ask the admin to set the key, then **Reprocess**.
Job finished in seconds with strange rooms ("Entrance 44 × 44 m")	The AI did not run (no key, service down, or no readable sheet). Check the pipeline messages and the Sheets tab; reprocess once the service is back.
"preview could not be rendered"	Drawing too heavy to draw in time. Reading continues from text and CAD facts. Purge the DWG or upload the PDF plot as well.
"DWG conversion failed for …"	The file is not a DWG, is password-protected, or uses a format the converter cannot read. Save as AutoCAD 2018 DWG or DXF and upload again.
Job *Failed*: "No sheets could be read"	None of the files produced a readable sheet (empty PDF, image-only PDF with no content, corrupt file). Check the files and re-upload.
"Room X: size missing, skipped"	No dimensions found for that room. Add L × W on the Elements tab or include the dimensioned plan.
"Door D5: room 'RECEPTION' not found …"	The door schedule names a room that is not in the Rooms list, so no deduction was made. Add the room or correct the door's room field.
Processing is slow (10 minutes per sheet)	Usually the AI service is slow that day; the job still completes. Large DWGs also take longer to convert and render.
Server memory limit on Render ("instance exceeded memory")	A very large DXF needs more RAM than the instance has. The app skips files above its limit with a message; the admin can move to a larger instance (2 GB recommended).
Download Excel is disabled	The job is not yet *Ready for review*, or there are unsaved element edits — save or discard first.
Approve is disabled	Only reviewers and admins can approve, only jobs in *Ready for review*, and not while edits are unsaved.

FAQ

Can I measure a PDF without the DWG? Yes. A vector PDF (plotted from CAD) keeps exact text and is read well; a scanned PDF is read from the image with lower confidence.

Does the app price the BOQ? No. Rates are blank by design; the estimator fills them in Excel and the amount formulas take over.

Where does steel come from? From thumb rules (kg per cum of concrete), clearly marked. Use the bar bending schedule for tender quantities.

Can I change the consumption norms? Yes, an admin can update them on the server (Standards). The Excel shows the norm used on every row.

Is my drawing sent anywhere? The drawing is stored in the company's Supabase storage and the sheet image plus text is sent to Google's Gemini API for reading. No other third party is involved.

19 Appendix A — Item codes

Each block on the measurement sheet and each BOQ line carries an item code. Codes are stable so sheets can be compared across jobs.

Code	Unit	Item
RCC-WALL / RCC-COL / RCC-BEAM / RCC-SLAB	cum	Reinforced concrete in walls, columns, beams, slabs (grade from Assumptions).
FW-WALL / FW-COL / FW-BEAM / FW-SLAB	sqm	Formwork (shuttering) contact area for the same members.
STEEL	kg	Reinforcement steel by thumb rule (basis: thumb rule).
BLOCK-CUM / BLOCK-SQM	cum / sqm	Block masonry: thick walls in cum, thin partitions in sqm.
PLASTER-INT / PLASTER-CLG	sqm	Internal wall plaster 12 mm; ceiling plaster 6 mm.
FLOOR-<finish>	sqm	Flooring, one item per finish (e.g. FLOOR-fc-201-1200x1200mm-stone).
SKIRT	rmt	Skirting to match flooring.
DADO	sqm	Wall tiles in wet areas up to the dado height.
PAINT-WALL / PAINT-CLG	sqm	Putty, primer and emulsion on walls / ceilings (system from the room's finish).
WP	sqm	Waterproofing to wet areas, floor plus 300 mm upturn.
DOOR-<tag> / WIN-<tag>	nos / sqm	Doors and windows, one item per tag with size and description.
MISC-<trade>-n	as given	Other countable items (joinery, electrical, plumbing, sanitary, miscellaneous).

Trades appear in this order: RCC, Masonry, Plaster, Flooring, Wall tiles, Painting, Waterproofing, Doors & Windows, Joinery, Plumbing, Electrical, Sanitary, Miscellaneous.

20 Appendix B — Default material norms

Required material = BOQ quantity × norm × (1 + wastage %). These defaults follow common Indian estimating practice and can be changed by an admin.

For item	Material	Norm per unit	Unit	Wastage
RCC (per cum)	Ready-mix concrete	1.0	cum	2 %
STEEL (per kg)	TMT bars Fe500D / Binding wire	1.0 / 0.009	kg	3 % / 0 %
Formwork (per sqm)	Shuttering oil	0.08	litre	0 %
Block masonry (per cum)	AAC blocks 600×200×200 / Cement (1:4) / Sand	41.7 / 1.2 / 0.15	nos / bags / cum	3 / 3 / 5 %

Block partition (per sqm)	AAC blocks 600×200×150 / Cement / Sand	8.3 / 0.18 / 0.022	nos / bags / cum	3 / 3 / 5 %
Internal plaster 12 mm (per sqm)	Cement / Sand	0.105 / 0.0144	bags / cum	3 / 5 %
Ceiling plaster 6 mm (per sqm)	Cement / Sand	0.065 / 0.0075	bags / cum	3 / 5 %
Flooring (per sqm)	Tiles or stone / Cement (20 mm bed 1:4) / Sand / Adhesive-grout	1.0 / 0.16 / 0.021 / 0.5	sqm / bags / cum / kg	7 / 3 / 5 / 5 %
Skirting (per rmt)	Skirting strips (600 mm)	1.67	nos	7 %
Dado (per sqm)	Wall tiles / Tile adhesive	1.0 / 4.0	sqm / kg	7 / 5 %
Paint (per sqm)	Wall putty / Primer / Interior emulsion	1.2 / 0.08 / 0.12	kg / litre / litre	5 % each
Waterproofing (per sqm)	Compound / membrane	1.0	sqm	5 %
Doors (per nos) / Windows (per sqm)	Door set with frame & hardware / Aluminium window fabricated to size	1.0	nos / sqm	0 %

Steel thumb rules (kg per cum of concrete): walls 125, columns 200, beams 150, slabs 85.

21 Appendix C — API endpoints

For integrators. All endpoints are under `/api/v1`, use JSON, and need the bearer token from `POST /auth/login`. Interactive documentation: `/docs` on the API host.

Endpoint	Purpose
POST /auth/login · POST /auth/set-password · GET /me	Sign in, change password, current profile.
POST /jobs (multipart) · GET /jobs · GET /jobs/{id} · DELETE /jobs/{id}	Create a job with files and fields project_name, level, location; list; read; delete.
GET /jobs/{id}/sheets · GET …/sheets/{sid}/preview · GET …/sheets/{sid}/extraction	Sheets of a job, preview image, raw AI extraction for a sheet.
PUT /jobs/{id}/elements	Replace the element list (rooms, openings, walls, slabs, members, misc, assumptions) and recompute.
POST /jobs/{id}/reprocess · POST /jobs/{id}/recalculate	Run the pipeline again; recompute from current inputs.
POST /jobs/{id}/approve · POST /jobs/{id}/reject	Reviewer sign-off / send back with a reason.
GET /jobs/{id}/export.xlsx	Download the workbook (ready or approved jobs).
GET /stats · GET /system · GET /ai/status · GET /standards · PUT /standards	Dashboard counters, system info, AI status, company standards (PUT is admin).
GET /admin/users · POST /admin/invite · PATCH /admin/users/{uid} · POST …/reset-password · DELETE …	User management (admin).
GET /admin/audit · GET /admin/backup	Audit log and database backup (admin).

The structural (members / items) endpoints from the earlier release remain available for old jobs only.

22 Appendix D — Glossary

BOQ	Bill of Quantities — the list of work items with quantities (and, when priced, rates and amounts).
Measurement sheet	The detailed working that shows how each BOQ quantity was derived, object by object.
IS 1200	Indian Standard "Method of measurement of building and civil engineering works"; defines what to measure, in which unit, and which deductions to make.
CPWD description	The standard wording of work items used by the Central Public Works Department (e.g. "Providing and laying …").
Deduction	A minus row that removes the area or volume of an opening or overlap from an item.

Contact area	Formwork is measured by the area of shuttering in contact with concrete.
Thumb rule	An approximate ratio used when detailed data is not available (e.g. kg of steel per cum of concrete).
Norm	Standard consumption of a material per unit of work (e.g. 0.105 bags of cement per sqm of 12 mm plaster).
Wastage	Extra material allowed for cutting, breakage and handling, as a percentage.
DWG / DXF	AutoCAD drawing formats; DXF is the open text version the readers use.
Model space / layout	In CAD, the model space holds the real-size drawing; layouts are the plotted sheets.
Hatch	A filled pattern in CAD that marks an area (e.g. a floor finish zone).
Mivan	Aluminium-formwork construction where walls and slabs are cast in RCC monolithically.
Tender vs Site	Comparison of the quantities estimated at tender with those measured on site during execution.